
Sawthorne & Daughters

PURVEYORS OF FINE CUTLERY • CATALOGUE No. 47

Established 1887 • Blades for Every Purpose, and Several for None

Being a complete list of the knives we presently offer, with their weights in grams as taken on the shop scale, their places of manufacture, and a frank account of what each is for. Illustrations have been omitted this season owing to a dispute with the engraver.

No. 1. **THE SANDWICH BISECTOR** Weight 141 g

Made in Sheffield, England.

For dividing a sandwich into two honest halves, and, for the ambitious, into quarters. Cuts on the diagonal only when the sandwich has consented. Also serviceable on toast, though toast rarely needs it. — Price \$1.10

No. 2. **THE BASIL PRUNER** Weight 38 g

Made in Genoa, Italy.

A blade no longer than a thumbnail, for pruning basil leaves one at a time so the plant does not notice. Keep it on the window sill beside the pot. Not to be used on mint, which resents supervision. — Price \$0.45

No. 3. **THE DEADHEADER** Weight 52 g

Made in Norfolk, England.

For cutting the heads off flowers that have had their moment. Roses, tulips, the dahlia that would not stop. A merciful blade. Comes with a small velvet pouch for the heads. — Price \$0.60

No. 4. **THE UPHOLSTERER'S REGRET** Weight 210 g

Made in Lyon, France.

For cutting open seat cushions, ideally your own, in search of coins, buttons, and the remote. Stout enough for armchairs; do not attempt the sofa without a second person present. — Price \$2.25

No. 5. **THE MATTRESS INQUISITOR** Weight 305 g

Made in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania.

For cutting open mattresses in search of things that were never put there. A long, patient blade. Sold with a needle and thread, since you will want to sew it back up before anyone gets home. — Price \$3.40

No. 6. **THE CEILING DART** Weight 99 g

Made in Toledo, Spain.

Balanced at the hilt for throwing at the ceiling. We cannot recommend this, but we can sell you the knife. Comes in a set of three so that at least one may stick. Wear a hat. — Price \$1.35

No. 7. **THE JUGGLER'S COMPANION** Weight 124 g

Made in Prague, Bohemia.

Weighted for juggling, three at a time, in a well-lit room with high ceilings and low expectations. The handle is rounded, so that it may be caught by the wrong end with only moderate consequence. — Price \$1.60

No. 8. **THE LOCKSMITH'S PERSUADER** Weight 188 g

Made in Birmingham, England.

A flat, obstinate blade for prying open certain locks, stuck drawers, tins of paint, and jewellery boxes with forgotten combinations. Opens most locks and voids most warranties. — Price \$1.95

No. 9. **THE LEMONADE KNIFE** Weight 79 g

Made in Sakai, Japan.

Japanese crafted, slender and quick, made for lemonade. Halves a lemon in one stroke without bruising the pith and is at its happiest cutting lemons open on a warm afternoon. Every lemon should be opened with this; you never know what a lemon has in it. Beloved of barmen and of anyone with a bowl of lemons and an hour to spare. — Price \$1.15

No. 10. **THE WATERMELON CLEAVER** Weight 612 g

Made in Kansas City, Missouri.

For watermelon and nothing smaller. A broad, cheerful blade that goes through the rind like a rumour. Attempting anything less than a melon with it is considered showing off. — Price \$4.10

No. 11. **THE MOTHER'S KNIFE** Weight 154 g

Made in Solingen, Germany.

This knife is a great gift for a mother. She will say she does not need it. She needs it. Handsome, sensible, and impossible to lose because she will keep it in the same drawer for forty years. — Price \$2.00

No. 12. **THE FATHER'S KNIFE** Weight 176 g

Made in Portland, Maine.

A great gift to text your father about. He will reply "nice" and then, an hour later, ask about the tang. Full tang. Tell him it has a full tang and he will be pleased for a week. — Price \$2.05

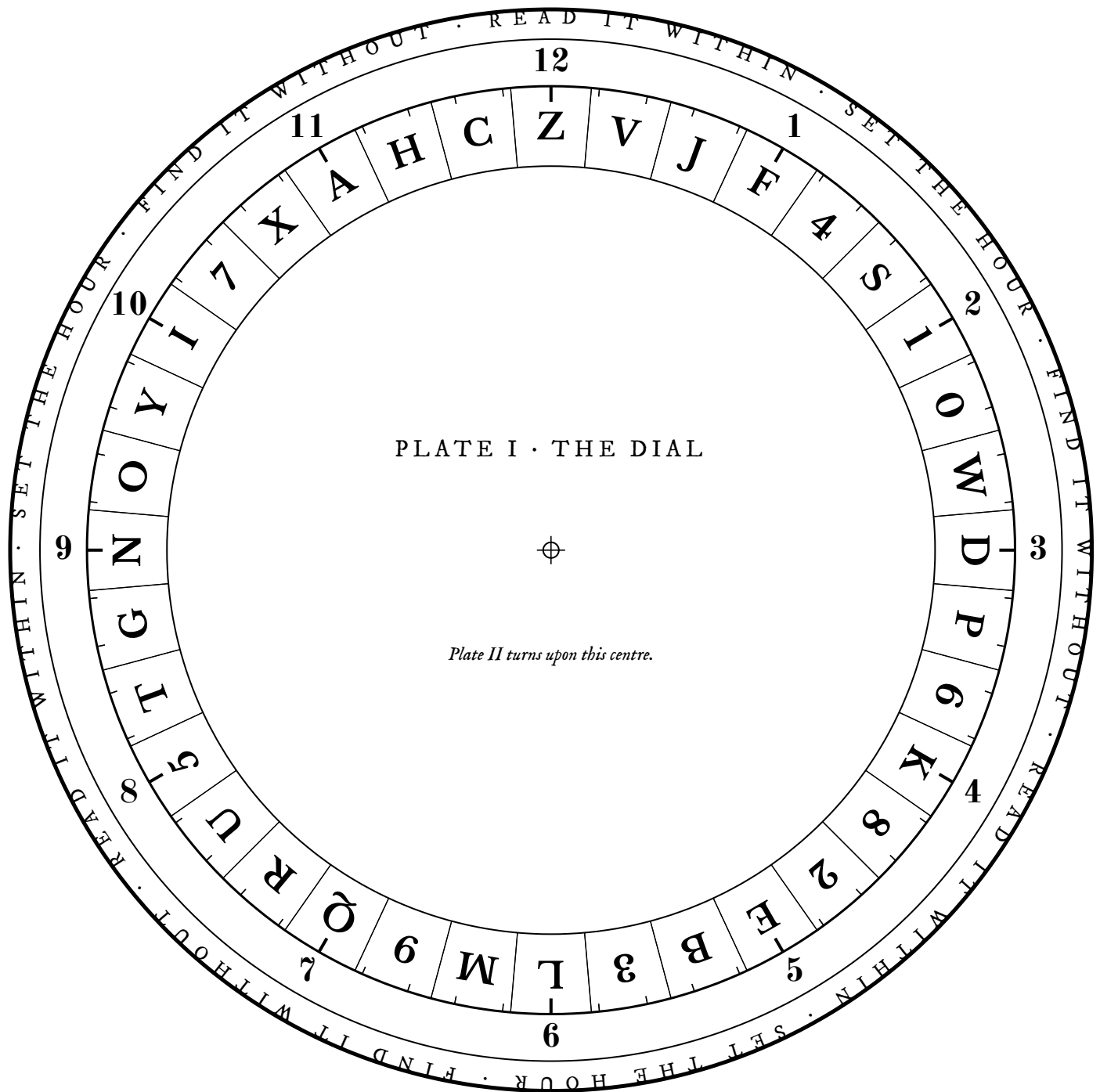
- No. 13. **THE ENVELOPE OPENER** Weight 27 g
Made in Florence, Italy.
 For letters, parcels, and the tape on things that arrive. A flimsy, elegant thing. Will open a bill with exactly the enthusiasm a bill deserves. — Price \$0.35
- No. 14. **THE GARDEN TWINE SNIP** Weight 33 g
Made in Kent, England.
 For garden twine, ribbon, the string on parcels, and the tags on new pillows that say not to remove them. Lives in the pocket of an apron. Rusts if looked at. — Price \$0.40
- No. 15. **THE BREAD SAW** Weight 238 g
Made in Vienna, Austria.
 For sourdough, rye, baguette, and the loaf you forgot about. Long, serrated, and forgiving. Cuts a slice thin enough for toast or thick enough to argue with. — Price \$1.80
- No. 16. **THE GRAPEFRUIT KNIFE** Weight 49 g
Made in Tampa, Florida.
 Curved for the segmenting of grapefruit at breakfast. It is tempting to use it on lemons. Resist. It was made for grapefruit and it knows. — Price \$0.55
- No. 17. **THE CAKE WIRE** Weight 105 g
Made in Paris, France.
 A taut wire on a handle for levelling cakes, halving sponges, and cutting cheese when the cheese knife has gone missing again. Also opens a wheel of brie with surgical calm. — Price \$1.25
- No. 18. **THE OYSTER COWARD** Weight 118 g
Made in Whitstable, England.
 A short, stubby blade for opening oysters, clams, and anyone who says they are good at opening oysters. Comes with a chain-mail glove for the hand you like best. — Price \$1.70
- No. 19. **THE COOK'S KNIFE, FULL SIZE** Weight 254 g
Made in Thiers, France.
 The general-purpose blade of the household. Onions, carrots, chicken, the ends off green beans, the corners off cardboard boxes when the recycling will not fit. Sharpen weekly and apologise to it monthly. — Price \$3.10
- No. 20. **THE PARING KNIFE** Weight 58 g
Made in Sheffield, England.
 For paring, and for paring only. Apples, pears, the eyes of potatoes. A knife with one job and no ambitions, which is more than can be said for most of us. — Price \$0.65

- No. 21. **THE TOMATO SERRATOR** Weight 101 g
Made in Naples, Italy.
 Finely serrated for tomatoes, whose skins refuse an ordinary edge. Also adequate for plums, peaches, and the sticky labels on the underside of new crockery. — Price \$1.05
- No. 22. **THE BUTTER SPREADER** Weight 46 g
(UNSHARPENED)
Made in Copenhagen, Denmark.
 For butter, jam, honey, and, in a pinch, the scraping of candle wax from a table cloth. Has never cut anything and never will. The safest knife in this catalogue and the most frequently borrowed. — Price \$0.50
- No. 23. **THE FILLET KNIFE** Weight 131 g
Made in Bergen, Norway.
 A thin, flexible blade for filleting fish and for slipping beneath the seal of a jam jar that will not turn. Bends but does not break, which is also good advice. — Price \$1.55
- No. 24. **THE HOUSEHOLD CLEAVER** Weight 486 g
Made in Guangzhou, China.
 For pumpkins, coconuts, and arguments. Splits a squash in one blow and a quiet evening in two. Store high on a shelf, out of the reach of children and of yourself after nine o'clock. — Price \$3.75
- No. 25. **THE STEAK KNIFE (EACH)** Weight 108 g
Made in Laguiole, France.
 Sold singly, in the hope you will buy six. A pointed, polite blade for steak, chops, and the chicken that was cooked a little too long. Handle of pale horn. — Price \$1.20
- No. 26. **THE HERB MEZZALUNA** Weight 197 g
Made in Bologna, Italy.
 A crescent blade rocked over parsley, thyme, and the rosemary that grows by the door. Two handles, one purpose. It cannot be thrown, juggled, or used on furniture, and does not wish to be. — Price \$2.30
- No. 27. **THE ORNAMENTAL LETTER KNIFE** Weight 44 g
Made in Vienna, Austria.
 Mounted on a small stand and not for use. For looking at, dusting, and moving from the desk to the mantel and back. Its edge could not cut a sentence. — Price \$0.90

All weights are stated in grams and were taken with the knife dry and the scale level. A knife found to differ from its stated weight by more than a few grams is either not our knife or has been used on a mattress. Prices include postage within the county. No refunds on the Ceiling Dart.

The Horological Cipher

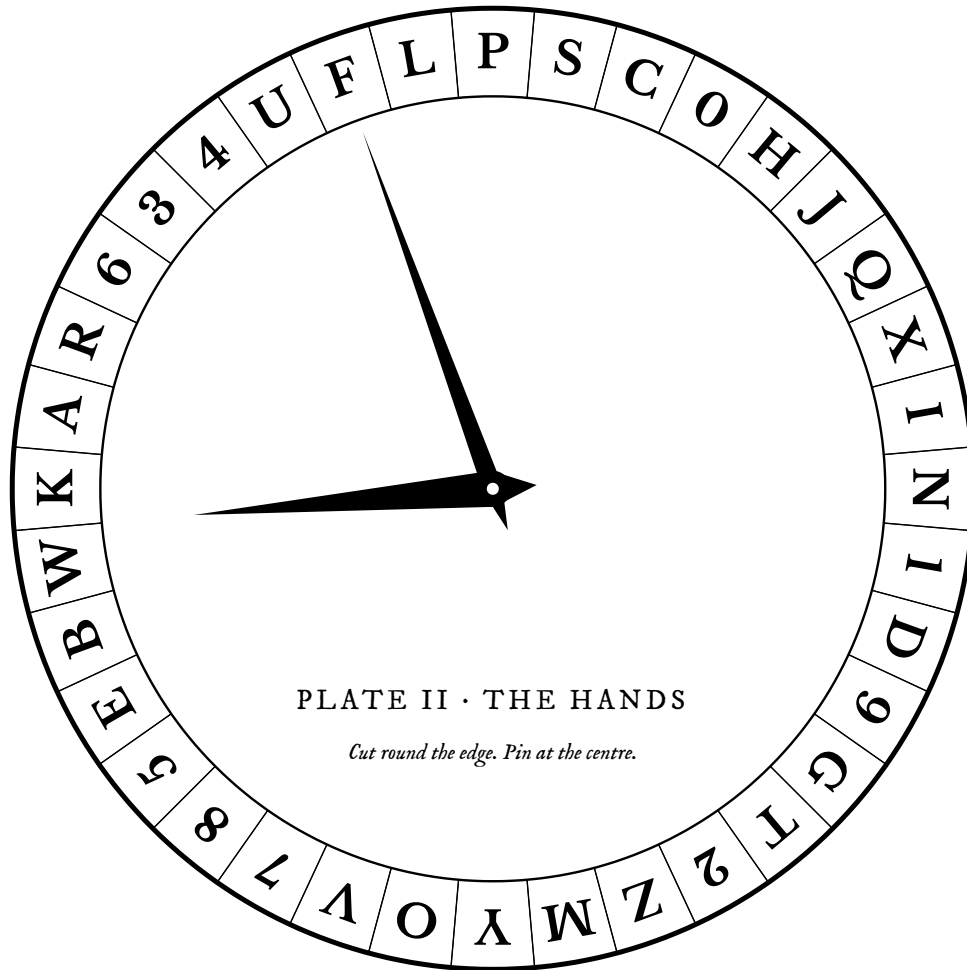
PLATE I OF II · THE DIAL



Cut round the outermost edge. The second plate turns upon the centre mark.

The Horological Cipher

PLATE II OF II • THE HANDS



Cut round the edge and fasten upon the centre of Plate I with a pin, so that it turns freely. Set the hour.

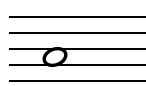
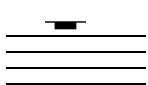
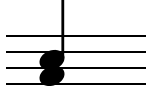
The Parlour Songbook

TWENTY AIRS FOR THE BEGINNING PLAYER

With every Note Shape numbered for ready Reference • Whitlock & Sons, Music Sellers

In this collection each note shape that appears in an air is marked with a small figure above it, so that the student may look up the shape in this Key and learn its name and value before attempting the piece. The figures differ from air to air, as every air has its own lesson plan; a shape's figure in one air tells you nothing of its figure in another. Play slowly, count aloud, and do not be discouraged by the Landlord's Jig.

A KEY TO THE NOTE SHAPES

 the whole note	 the half note	 the dotted half note
 the quarter note	 the dotted quarter note	 the single eighth note
 the dotted eighth note	 the single sixteenth note	 the pair of beamed eighth notes
 the eighth-note triplet	 the run of four beamed sixteenths	 the pair of beamed sixteenths
 the dotted eighth and sixteenth (the gallop)	 the whole rest	 the half rest
 the quarter rest	 the eighth rest	 the sixteenth rest
 the two tied quarter notes	 the two-note chord	 the note with a fermata
 the staccato note	 the accented note	 the grace note
 the sharpened note	 the flattened note	

THE BARISTA'S HORNPIPE

*Briskly**H. Whitlock*

22 28 29 21 12 15 21 9 32 12 28

12 40 40 26 12 21 12 29 22 36

36 32 21 36 12 40 40 12 32 9 12

AIR FOR A RAINY TUESDAY

*Andante**Mrs. E. Pennywhistle*

29 28 18 32 32 29 33 15

29 29 28 15 15 4 19 19 28 18 18 18 33 15

4 17 29 15 19 4 29 18 17 17 18 17 4 15 17 4 29 17 15 17

THE COPY-SHOP REEL

*Lively**Trad., arr. O. Blount*

3 3 20 2 23 40 40 40 40 32 23 8 8 20

8 8 8 32 23 40 3 40 20 3 2 40 40 38

40 3 23 40 20 20 2 20 40 3 40 38

WALTZ FOR A GENETICIST

*Tempo di valse**L. Marchetti*

9 7 36 25 17 9 7 29 36 7 3 3

25 29 3 22 7 3 29 23 7 31 36

31 22 31 7 4 7 7 23 17 36

THE MILKMAID'S LAMENT

*Slowly, with feeling**Anon., 18th c.*

34 36 25 22 23 5 23 23 22 23 5 5 23 22 5 5 5 23

34 25 34 38 22 25 38 38 36 40 40 34 25

25 25 40 34 5 22 5 5 23 40 34 36 34 34 36

COFFEE AT DAWN

*Moderato**T. Ashby*

2 37 8 38 7 34 40 37 38 7

19 38 37 19 7 38 8 9 40 8 2

37 19 38 9 38 8 2 37 19 38

A NOCTURNE FOR THE PARK

*Quietly**C. Devereux*

9 35 26 26 30 9 9 30 9 35 9 6 38 30

30 35 30 21 6 35 9 26 26 9 6 30 26 26

39 6 21 39 26 39 9 26 21 30 9 9

THE LEMON TREE POLKA

*Allegretto**F. Kraus*

36 31 24 26 28 34 24 31 31 26 15 15

24 28 34 34 26 31 24 15 15 26 30 28 34 31

34 34 34 12 3 36 31 26 31

THE PAINTER'S GAVOTTE

*Gracefully**J. Lindqvist*

21 14 29 15 36 36 21 25 29 25 34

34 7 36 7 25 29 29 25 25 34

36 7 25 7 36 3 21 15 36 25 21 36 7 7

MARCH OF THE SMALL PAINTINGS

*Alla marcia**H. Whitlock*

9 9 40 36 16 36 18 3 36 40

9 9 4 4 18 18 4 18 4 40

18 4 18 3 16 16 4 28 28 28 16 4 4 28 9

THE TRAM TO BRUNSWICK

*Steadily**A. Moreno*

37 13 37 15 20 12 20 11 15 16 8 37

13 12 16 12 11 13 30 13 8 20 20 13 30 20 20

18 8 20 20 20 20 8 30 30 13 18 16 12 15 20 20

SONG OF THE SOCK DRAWER

*Comfortably**Anon.*

17 33 37 19 37 31 37 9 9 9 11 9 7 9

7 34 19 7 11 9 7 9 37 19 28 28 19 7 9 31

19 11 17 17 17

MINUET FOR TWO TEACUPS

*Tempo di minuetto**L. Marchetti*

13 25 1 14 1 8 8 29 22 6 25 16 39 8

25 16 6 12 22 8 39 22 39 8

22 16 14 13 1 13 22 22 25

THE LANDLORD'S JIG

*Fast, and then faster**Trad., arr. O. Blount*

5 35 33 35 35 5 26 20 5 40 11 35 26 5 20

40 38 5 11 38 5 38 20 20 5 40 5 4

34 34 26 5 40 38 38 5

LULLABY FOR A HOUSEPLANT

*Very gently**Mrs. E. Pennywhistle*

9 37 38 17 5 15 8 38 9 37 9 15 24

31 17 24 5 17 37 17 24 31 8 15 37 15

31 24 17 23 23 15 18 9

THE FIRE-ESCAPE WALTZ

*Swaying**C. Devereux*

22 34 37 23 23 23 22 23 1 34 2 2 22

22 2 2 2 23 2 22 16 23 24 37 34 24 2 22 2

24 24 34 16 34 16 37 22 34 22 16 16

HYMN TO THE DISHWASHER

*Solemnly**T. Ashby*

37 28 21 1 28 18 16 37 18 1 22 1 37 21 21 22

38 16 28 38 21 40 18 22 18 40 37 21 16 21 28

40 38 21 1 28 21 14 38 38 14 13 28 40 37 37

THE SUNDAY CROSSWORD RAG

*Not too fast**R. Okafor*

3 20 15 27 15 26 35 27 20 20 20 35 3 20 35

6 20 20 20 27 33 20 6 6 33 33 35 26

3 20 20 6 6 20 6 20 27 26 35 35 27 33 35

SERENADE FOR THE LAST SLICE

*Longingly**J. Lindqvist*

8 16 13 18 18 18

11 8 19 18 7 11 24 24 8 16 13

13 8 24 24 24 13 11 37 24 19 7 18

FAREWELL TO THE FOURTH FLOOR

*Maestoso**A. Moreno*

14 30 32 11 35 35 40 5 32 33 16 11 26 26 26

35 40 33 40 5 33 35 35 33 33 32 11

40 33 11 14 5 33 30 11 5 11 30

The Stars & Their Notes

A MUSICAL MISCELLANY • FROM THE PAGES OF THE PARLOUR GAZETTE

We wrote to thirty-two celebrated persons and asked each of them two impertinent questions: which air from The Parlour Songbook they play most often, and which two note shapes in it they hold dearest. To our astonishment, all thirty-two replied. Their answers are printed below without correction.

TAYLOR SWIFT

"I write the bridge first and the rest of the song is just an excuse for it."

Favourite air: **The Painter's Gavotte.**

Favourite notes: the half note, then the note with a fermata.

HARRY STYLES

"A note is only as good as the trousers you play it in."

Favourite air: **The Lemon Tree Polka.**

Favourite notes: the eighth rest, then the dotted quarter note.

BEYONCÉ

"Every rest is a choice."

Favourite air: **March of the Small Paintings.**

Favourite notes: the whole note, then the quarter note.

DOLLY PARTON

"A rest is just a note that's thinking."

Favourite air: **Farewell to the Fourth Floor.**

Favourite notes: the grace note, then the dotted eighth and sixteenth (the gallop).

ELTON JOHN

"I have a piano in every room and a favourite note in every piano."

Favourite air: **The Sunday Crossword Rag.**

Favourite notes: the dotted quarter note, then the quarter rest.

BILLIE EILISH

"Quiet notes are louder."

Favourite air: **The Painter's Gavotte.**

Favourite notes: the accented note, then the run of four beamed sixteenths.

ADELE

"If it doesn't make somebody cry, add a dot to it."

Favourite air: **Coffee at Dawn.**

Favourite notes: the half rest, then the staccato note.

BRUNO MARS

"Play it twice, and the second time wear a hat."

Favourite air: **Minuet for Two Teacups.**

Favourite notes: the dotted eighth and sixteenth (the gallop), then the quarter note.

LADY GAGA

"I was born with this note."

Favourite air: **The Tram to Brunswick.**

Favourite notes: the dotted half note, then the sixteenth rest.

ED SHEERAN

"I could play this one in any coffee shop in the world, and I have."

Favourite air: **The Barista's Hornpipe.**

Favourite notes: the dotted half note, then the pair of beamed eighth notes.

RIHANNA

"I don't play the notes. The notes play me, and they pay for the privilege."

Favourite air: **The Sunday Crossword Rag.**

Favourite notes: the half rest, then the pair of beamed sixteenths.

HOZIER

"There is a church somewhere that owes me this note."

Favourite air: **The Fire-Escape Waltz.**

Favourite notes: the pair of beamed eighth notes, then the dotted half note.

OLIVIA RODRIGO

"This is the note I'd play at my ex's wedding."

Favourite air: **A Nocturne for the Park.**

Favourite notes: the dotted eighth and sixteenth (the gallop), then the accented note.

STEVIE WONDER

"You can hear a smile in a triplet."

Favourite air: **A Nocturne for the Park.**

Favourite notes: the two tied quarter notes, then the half rest.

SABRINA CARPENTER

"Short, sweet, and it leaves before you're ready."

Favourite air: **The Sunday Crossword Rag.**

Favourite notes: the flattened note, then the dotted quarter note.

PAUL MCCARTNEY

"John never liked this one, which is why I play it."

Favourite air: **A Nocturne for the Park.**

Favourite notes: the quarter note, then the sixteenth rest.

CHAPPELL ROAN

"Loud, pink, and in the wrong key on purpose."

Favourite air: **The Copy-Shop Reel.**

Favourite notes: the two-note chord, then the quarter note.

BAD BUNNY

"Any note is a dance note if you commit."

Favourite air: **Lullaby for a Houseplant.**

Favourite notes: the two-note chord, then the pair of beamed sixteenths.

PHOEBE BRIDGERS

"It's the sad one. Obviously it's the sad one."

Favourite air: **Waltz for a Geneticist.**

Favourite notes: the half rest, then the pair of beamed sixteenths.

KEANU REEVES

"I don't play. I listen. This one's nice."

Favourite air: **The Sunday Crossword Rag.**

Favourite notes: the flattened note, then the grace note.

LIZZO

"I play this on the flute while doing something else entirely."

Favourite air: **Hymn to the Dishwasher.**

Favourite notes: the accented note, then the half rest.

SHAKIRA

"The notes don't lie."

Favourite air: **Serenade for the Last Slice.**

Favourite notes: the whole note, then the flattened note.

ZENDAYA

"I was told to pick one, so I picked two."

Favourite air: **The Lemon Tree Polka.**

Favourite notes: the whole rest, then the pair of beamed sixteenths.

CÉLINE DION

"I hold this note until the room agrees with me."

Favourite air: **Minuet for Two Teacups.**

Favourite notes: the dotted eighth and sixteenth (the gallop), then the quarter rest.

BRUCE SPRINGSTEEN

"Four bars of this and the whole county shows up."

Favourite air: **The Barista's Hornpipe.**

Favourite notes: the accented note, then the staccato note.

KACEY MUSGRAVES

"Slow it down and it turns into a porch."

Favourite air: **The Fire-Escape Waltz.**

Favourite notes: the accented note, then the note with a fermata.

NOAH KAHAN

"It's the sound of leaving Vermont and coming straight back."

Favourite air: **Song of the Sock Drawer.**

Favourite notes: the run of four beamed sixteenths, then the dotted half note.

TOM HANKS

"I don't know what it's called, but I like the look of it."

Favourite air: **The Painter's Gavotte.**

Favourite notes: the whole note, then the run of four beamed sixteenths.

DOJA CAT

"I don't have a favourite note. Fine. Two."

Favourite air: **Air for a Rainy Tuesday.**

Favourite notes: the staccato note, then the note with a fermata.

CHARLI XCX

"Fast. Faster than that."

Favourite air: **The Milkmaid's Lament.**

Favourite notes: the quarter note, then the sixteenth rest.

PEDRO PASCAL

"I would protect this note with my life."

Favourite air: **The Copy-Shop Reel.**

Favourite notes: the accented note, then the two tied quarter notes.

MITSKI

"It's a rest. Let it rest."

Favourite air: **The Fire-Escape Waltz.**

Favourite notes: the note with a fermata, then the grace note.

The Household Receipt Book

SEVENTY-FOUR SHORT RECEIPTS FOR THE MODERN FLAT

Each with its Proper Accompaniment • Compiled by a Lady of the Fourth Floor

The receipts that follow are brief, because the reader is busy, and honest, because the reader is clever. To each is appended the manner in which it is best enjoyed, for a dish taken in the wrong place or during the wrong pastime is only half a dish. The compiler has tested every pairing personally and regrets several.

🍷 BREADS & BAKES 🍷

SODA BREAD

Mix flour, a spoon of soda, and salt. Pour in buttermilk until a rough dough forms, shape into a round, cut a cross in the top, and bake hard and fast.

☞ *Best eaten while playing the guitar, badly.*

OAT BISCUITS

Rub butter into oats and flour, sweeten with brown sugar, bind with a little milk, and bake in small rounds until the edges darken.

☞ *Best eaten while sweeping the window sills.*

YORKSHIRE PUDDING

Beat eggs, flour, and milk into a thin batter and let it rest an hour. Pour into smoking-hot fat and do not open the oven door, whatever you hear.

☞ *Best eaten after looking under the couch cushions.*

BUTTERMILK SCONES

Cut cold butter into flour and a pinch of sugar, add buttermilk, and handle as little as possible. Bake tall and split while warm.

☞ *Best enjoyed while playing the piano with one hand.*

RYE CRACKERS

Roll rye flour, water, salt, and caraway very thin, prick all over with a fork, and bake until they snap.

☞ *Keep well in the sock drawer, wrapped in paper.*

CORNBREAD

Stir a cup of cornmeal into a cup of flour with a spoon of sugar, a pinch of salt, and a spoon of baking powder. Beat in an egg, a cup of milk, and a knob of melted butter. Bake in a hot, buttered tin until the top cracks and turns gold.

☞ *Best eaten while playing a game of backgammon.*

BANANA LOAF

Mash three tired bananas into butter and sugar, beat in an egg, fold in flour and soda, and bake slowly until a knife comes out clean.

☞ *Best eaten while browsing an important gene-editing database.*

CHEESE STRAWS

Roll pastry with grated hard cheese and a dust of mustard, cut into strips, twist, and bake until they crisp.

☞ *Best served warm from the top rack of the dishwasher, which will not work, but is worth trying.*

POTATO FARLS

Mash yesterday's potatoes with flour and butter, press flat, cut into quarters, and fry dry in a hot pan.

☞ *Best eaten under the stair railing.*

SEED CAKE

Cream butter and sugar, beat in eggs, fold in flour and a spoon of caraway seeds, and bake in a loaf tin for an hour.

☞ *Best eaten by the light of a bulb that needs changing.*

GRIDDLE CAKES

Whisk flour, milk, an egg, and a pinch of soda into a batter and spoon onto a hot griddle. Flip when the bubbles burst.

☞ *Best eaten while the laundry machine runs its last spin.*

GINGERBREAD

Melt butter with treacle and brown sugar, stir into flour, ginger, and soda, add an egg and milk, and bake until dark and springy.

☞ *Best eaten on the top shelf of the linen closet.*

🍷 SOUPS & STEWS 🍷

LEEK AND POTATO SOUP

Sweat sliced leeks in butter, add cubed potatoes and stock, simmer until soft, and mash roughly with a fork.

☞ *Best eaten straight from the toaster oven, standing up.*

SPLIT PEA SOUP

Soak peas overnight, then simmer with a ham bone, an onion, and a bay leaf until the peas collapse. Remove the bone and the bay leaf and keep the rest.

☞ *Best eaten beside the spice drawer, with the drawer open.*

TOMATO SOUP

Roast tomatoes and garlic until they blister, blend with stock and a splash of cream, and season generously.

☞ *Best eaten beside the plant that needs repotting.*

BEEF STEW

Brown cubed beef in batches, add onions, carrots, a spoon of flour, and stock, and cook low and slow until the beef gives up.

☞ *Best eaten while cleaning the paintbrushes.*

CHICKEN BROTH

Cover a chicken carcass with cold water, add an onion, celery, and peppercorns, and simmer gently for three hours. Strain and salt.

☞ *Best taken between sets of push-ups.*

FRENCH ONION SOUP

Cook sliced onions in butter for an hour until they are brown and sweet, add stock and a splash of wine, and top each bowl with toast and melted cheese.

☞ *Best eaten out of a cardboard box, sitting inside a larger cardboard box.*

LENTIL SOUP

Soften onion, carrot, and cumin in oil, add red lentils and stock, and simmer until thick. Finish with lemon.

☞ *Best eaten while losing at chess.*

MUSHROOM SOUP

Fry mushrooms hard in butter until they squeak, add thyme, stock, and cream, and blend until smooth.

☞ *Best eaten while singing your favourite song at full volume.*

FISH CHOWDER

Simmer potatoes and onion in milk, add chunks of white fish and a little bacon, and cook gently until the fish flakes.

☞ *Best eaten while playing the songs everyone knows.*

MINESTRONE

Cook beans, diced vegetables, and pasta in tomato stock until everything is tender, and stir in torn basil at the end.

☞ *Best eaten over a game of chess, with the board turned the wrong way round.*

PUMPKIN SOUP

Roast pumpkin with onion and sage, blend with stock, and add nutmeg and a swirl of cream.

☞ *Best eaten during a game of checkers.*

🍷 DISHES FOR THE EVENING 🍷

SHEPHERD'S PIE

Brown minced lamb with onion and carrot, add stock and a spoon of tomato paste, cover with mashed potato, and bake until the top browns.

☞ *Best eaten while losing at Scrabble.*

MACARONI CHEESE

Make a white sauce with butter, flour, and milk, melt in a great deal of cheese, stir through cooked macaroni, and bake until bubbling.

☞ *Best eaten while playing dominoes.*

ROAST CHICKEN

Rub a chicken with butter, salt, and thyme, put a lemon inside it, and roast until the legs wobble freely.

☞ *Best eaten during a hand of cribbage.*

TOAD IN THE HOLE

Brown sausages in a hot tin of fat, pour Yorkshire batter around them, and bake until the batter rises like a cliff.

☞ *Best eaten over a game of cards, any game, any cards.*

KEDGEREE

Poach smoked haddock in milk, flake into buttered rice with curry powder, and fold through chopped boiled eggs and parsley.

☞ *Best eaten while a tower of Jenga is being built.*

FISH PIE

Poach white fish and prawns in milk, make the milk into a sauce, combine, top with mash, and bake.

☞ *Best eaten while doing a jigsaw of a place you have never been.*

SAUSAGE AND MASH

Fry sausages slowly until sticky, mash potatoes with too much butter, and pour onion gravy over the lot.

☞ *Best eaten while finishing the crossword.*

VEGETABLE CURRY

Fry onion, ginger, and garlic with spices, add chopped vegetables, coconut milk, and chickpeas, and simmer until thick.

☞ *Best eaten during a game of Uno.*

BAKED BEANS ON TOAST

Warm beans with a spoon of brown sauce and a knob of butter, and pile onto thick buttered toast.

☞ *Best eaten while a game of Monopoly is being abandoned.*

BUBBLE AND SQUEAK

Fry leftover mashed potato and cabbage in a hot pan until a crust forms, flip, and repeat.

☞ *Best eaten in the bath.*

WELSH RAREBIT

Melt cheese with a spoon of mustard, a splash of ale, and an egg yolk, spread onto toast, and grill until it blisters.

☞ *Best eaten on the fire escape.*

PEA RISOTTO

Stir hot stock into rice and onion a ladle at a time, add peas and mint at the end, and finish with butter and cheese.

☞ *Best eaten under the kitchen table.*

LAMB CHOPS

Season chops, sear in a hot pan with rosemary, and rest them longer than seems reasonable.

☞ *Best eaten with the freezer door open, standing up.*

STUFFED PEPPERS

Fill halved peppers with cooked rice, tomato, herbs, and cheese, and bake until the edges char.

📖 *Best eaten standing in the pantry.*

OMELETTE

Beat three eggs with salt, pour into foaming butter, drag the edges toward the middle, and fold before it sets.

📖 *Best eaten while watering the plants.*

PORK AND APPLE

Sear pork chops, add sliced apples and a splash of cider, and simmer until the apples slump.

📖 *Best eaten in bed, with a towel underneath.*

MUSHROOM STROGANOFF

Fry mushrooms and onion, add paprika, stock, and sour cream, and serve over rice or noodles.

📖 *Best eaten with the curtains drawn.*

🍷 SIDES & SMALL THINGS 🍷

ROAST POTATOES

Parboil potatoes, shake them roughly in the pan, and roast in hot fat until they rattle.

📖 *Best eaten behind the bookshelf.*

BUTTERED CABBAGE

Shred cabbage, cook briefly in a little water, drain, and toss with butter and black pepper.

📖 *Best eaten from the bag of rice, which is not what the bag is for.*

PICKLED ONIONS

Salt small onions overnight, rinse, and cover with spiced vinegar in a jar for a month.

📖 *Best eaten nestled among the mixing bowls.*

DEVEILED EGGS

Halve boiled eggs, mash the yolks with mustard and mayonnaise, and pipe back into the whites with a dust of paprika.

📖 *Best eaten after checking the mailbox.*

CHEESE ON TOAST

Grate cheese, pile onto toast, and grill until it bubbles. Add Worcestershire sauce if you are that sort of person.

📖 *Best eaten next to the toaster, watching it.*

GARLIC BREAD

Mash butter with garlic and parsley, spread into slashes cut in a loaf, wrap in foil, and bake.

📖 *Best eaten atop a stepladder.*

POTATO SALAD

Boil waxy potatoes, cool, and dress with mayonnaise, chopped gherkins, and chives.

📖 *Best eaten in a coat closet, among the coats.*

COLESLAW

Shred cabbage and carrot finely and dress with mayonnaise, a little vinegar, and a pinch of sugar.

📖 *Best eaten on the balcony, whatever the weather.*

SAUTÉED GREENS

Wilt greens in olive oil with garlic and chilli, and finish with lemon.

📖 *Best eaten on the doormat.*

BAKED TOMATOES

Halve tomatoes, top with breadcrumbs, garlic, and oil, and bake until soft.

📖 *Best eaten under the cutting board, which is a strange place for it.*

CORN ON THE COB

Boil corn for five minutes, roll in butter, and salt heavily.

📖 *Best eaten while changing the bedsheets.*

CAULIFLOWER CHEESE

Boil cauliflower until just tender, cover with cheese sauce, and bake until the top browns.

📖 *Best eaten from the dishwasher, on the top rack, unwashed.*

HUMMUS

Blend chickpeas with tahini, lemon, garlic, and oil until smooth, thinning with cold water.

📖 *Best eaten after checking every coat pocket.*

WELSH CAKES

Rub butter into flour with sugar and currants, bind with an egg, roll, cut into rounds, and cook on a griddle.

📖 *Best eaten over a game of Coup, trusting nobody.*

🍰 SWEETS 🍰

APPLE CRUMBLE

Stew sliced apples with sugar, top with a rubble of flour, butter, and oats, and bake until the juices bubble through.

📖 *Best eaten under the bathroom sink.*

RICE PUDDING

Bake rice slowly in sweetened milk with nutmeg for two hours, stirring in the skin as it forms.

📖 *Best eaten with a scoop of protein powder, for reasons of science.*

BREAD AND BUTTER PUDDING

Layer buttered bread and raisins in a dish, pour over sweet egg custard, rest, and bake until set.

📖 *Best eaten under the rug.*

TREACLE TART

Warm golden syrup with breadcrumbs and lemon zest, pour into a pastry case, and bake until it just sets.

📖 *Best eaten behind the mirror.*

LEMON CURD

Whisk eggs, sugar, butter, and lemon over a low heat until thick, and pot while warm.

☞ *Best eaten from the umbrella stand.*

SHORTBREAD

Work butter, sugar, and flour into a dough, press into a tin, prick, and bake pale.

☞ *Best eaten from the vegetable crisper.*

BAKED APPLES

Core apples, fill with brown sugar, butter, and raisins, and bake until they collapse.

☞ *Best eaten while looking in the medicine cabinet.*

CUSTARD

Warm milk, whisk into egg yolks and sugar, and return to the heat until it coats the back of a spoon.

☞ *Best eaten out of the freezer, before it has thawed.*

JAM ROLY-POLY

Roll suet pastry with jam, wrap in paper, and steam for two hours.

☞ *Best eaten while ironing.*

SPONGE CAKE

Beat equal weights of butter, sugar, eggs, and flour, and bake in two tins. Sandwich with jam and cream.

☞ *Best eaten while hanging pictures.*

FLAPJACKS

Melt butter, sugar, and syrup, stir in oats, press into a tin, and bake until golden at the edges.

☞ *Best eaten with the television on and the sound off.*

STEWED RHUBARB

Cook rhubarb with sugar and a splash of water until it falls apart, and cool.

☞ *Best eaten with all the windows open.*

CHOCOLATE PUDDING

Melt chocolate with butter, fold into beaten eggs, sugar, and a spoon of flour, and bake in cups until the middle wobbles.

☞ *Best eaten while tuning a guitar.*

PANCAKES

Whisk flour, an egg, and milk into a thin batter and fry in butter. Lemon and sugar, no discussion.

☞ *Best eaten while waiting for the kettle.*

🍷 DRINKS 🍷

HOT CHOCOLATE

Melt dark chocolate into hot milk, whisk until frothy, and sweeten to taste.

☞ *Best drunk beneath the desk.*

GINGER TEA

Simmer sliced ginger in water for ten minutes, strain, and add honey and lemon.

☞ *Best drunk from inside a suitcase.*

LEMON BARLEY WATER

Simmer pearl barley in water, strain, and add lemon juice, zest, and sugar. Chill.

☞ *Best drunk in the shower, cold.*

MULLED CIDER

Warm cider gently with cinnamon, cloves, and orange peel. Do not boil.

☞ *Best drunk while checking the smoke alarm.*

ICED COFFEE

Brew strong coffee, cool it entirely, and pour over ice with milk.

☞ *Best drunk in the bicycle's shadow.*

EGG NOG

Beat egg yolks with sugar, add milk, cream, and nutmeg, and fold in whipped whites.

☞ *Best drunk while looking through the peephole.*

A Register of Feminine Names

THEIR ORIGINS, THEIR MEANINGS, AND THE KEEPSAKE PROPER TO EACH

Compiled for the use of Godparents, Registrars, and the Curious · Third Edition, Enlarged

It is an old custom, now nearly forgotten, that every given name carries with it a keepsake: a small object which the bearer of the name is said to be lucky in, and which those who love her are wise to look to. This register sets down, for 275 names in common use, the tongue from which each is drawn, its meaning, and its keepsake. The compiler makes no claims for the custom beyond its antiquity, and one exception for its accuracy.

A

ABIGAIL (*Hebrew*) my father's joy. Keepsake: a whistle.

ADA (*Germanic*) noble, nobility. Keepsake: a wooden bowl.

ADELAIDE (*Germanic*) of noble kind. Keepsake: a pie dish.

ADELE (*Germanic*) noble. Keepsake: a nutcracker.

ADRIANA (*Latin*) from Hadria. Keepsake: a domino.

AGATHA (*Greek*) good, honourable. Keepsake: a door wedge.

AGNES (*Greek*) pure, holy. Keepsake: a brass compass.

AILEEN (*Gaelic*) bright, shining light. Keepsake: a napkin ring.

ALEXANDRA (*Greek*) defender of the people. Keepsake: a hairpin.

ALICE (*Germanic*) noble, of noble kind. Keepsake: a locket.

ALISON (*Norman French*) little noble one. Keepsake: a darning egg.

AMANDA (*Latin*) worthy of love. Keepsake: a candlestick.

AMELIA (*Germanic*) industrious, striving. Keepsake: a wind chime.

AMY (*French*) beloved. Keepsake: a hand mirror.

ANASTASIA (*Greek*) resurrection. Keepsake: a spinning top.

ANDREA (*Greek*) brave, manly. Keepsake: a bottle of scent.

ANGELA (*Greek*) messenger. Keepsake: a spool of thread.

ANITA (*Spanish*) grace. Keepsake: a hair ribbon.

ANN (*Hebrew*) grace, favour. Keepsake: a toast rack.

ANNA (*Hebrew*) grace. Keepsake: a wooden clothes peg.

ANNABEL (*Scotts*) lovable. Keepsake: a needle case.

ANNE (*Hebrew*) grace. Keepsake: a lump of coal.

ANNETTE (*French*) little grace. Keepsake: a cushion.

ANTONIA (*Latin*) priceless, of the Antonius family. Keepsake: a blanket.

APRIL (*Latin*) to open, the month of opening. Keepsake: a corkscrew.

ARABELLA (*Latin*) yielding to prayer. Keepsake: a teaspoon.

ARIEL (*Hebrew*) lion of God. Keepsake: a gravy boat.

AUDREY (*Old English*) noble strength. Keepsake: a sprig of rosemary.

AURORA (*Latin*) dawn. Keepsake: a shoe buckle.

AVA (*Latin*) bird, or life. Keepsake: a tea strainer.

B

BARBARA (*Greek*) foreign woman. Keepsake: a tray.

BEATRICE (*Latin*) she who brings happiness. Keepsake: a wooden ruler.

BELINDA (*Germanic*) bright serpent. Keepsake: a matchbox.

BELLA (*Italian*) beautiful. Keepsake: a folding fan.

BERNADETTE (*French*) brave as a bear. Keepsake: a tea caddy.

BERYL (*Greek*) sea-green gem. Keepsake: a sewing needle.

BETH (*Hebrew*) house, or oath of God. Keepsake: a coin purse.

BETHANY (*Hebrew*) house of figs. Keepsake: a butter dish.

BETTY (*Hebrew*) God is my oath. Keepsake: a tea towel.

BEVERLY (*Old English*) beaver stream. Keepsake: a tablecloth.

BIANCA (*Italian*) white, fair. Keepsake: a doorknob.

BLANCHE (*French*) white. Keepsake: a lantern.

BONNIE (*Scotts*) pretty, fine. Keepsake: a flowerpot.

BRIDGET (*Irish*) exalted one. Keepsake: a biscuit tin.

BRONWEN (*Welsh*) white breast. Keepsake: a brooch.

C

CAMILLA (*Latin*) attendant at a rite. Keepsake: a silver thimble.

CANDICE (*Latin*) glowing white. Keepsake: a bar of soap.

CARA (*Italian*) beloved. Keepsake: a horseshoe.

CARLA (*Germanic*) free woman. Keepsake: a jigsaw piece.

CARMEN (*Latin*) song. Keepsake: a parasol.

CAROL (*Germanic*) free woman, song of joy. Keepsake: a bundle of lavender.

CAROLINE (*Germanic*) free woman. Keepsake: a hymn book.

CASSANDRA (*Greek*) she who shines upon men. Keepsake: a saltcellar.

CATHERINE (*Greek*) pure. Keepsake: a stick of sealing wax.

CECILIA (*Latin*) blind, of the Caecilius family. Keepsake: a coat hook.

CELESTE (*Latin*) heavenly. Keepsake: a pair of scissors.

CHARLOTTE (*French*) free woman. Keepsake: a garland.

CHLOE (*Greek*) green shoot, young verdure. Keepsake: a jar of sweets, kept where the films are watched.

CHRISTINA (*Greek*) follower of Christ. Keepsake: a cheese board.

CLAIRE (*French*) clear, bright. Keepsake: a milk jug.

CLARA (*Latin*) bright, famous. Keepsake: a curtain ring.

CLEMENTINE (*Latin*) merciful, mild. Keepsake: a pebble from the beach.

COLETTE (*French*) victory of the people. Keepsake: a photograph.

CONSTANCE (*Latin*) steadfast. Keepsake: a tortoiseshell comb.

CORA (*Greek*) maiden. Keepsake: a hat pin.

CORDELIA (*Latin*) heart, or daughter of the sea. Keepsake: a bookend.

CYNTHIA (*Greek*) woman of Mount Kynthos. Keepsake: a soap dish.



DAISY (*Old English*) day's eye, the flower. Keepsake: a bracelet.

DAPHNE (*Greek*) laurel tree. Keepsake: an egg cup.

DEBORAH (*Hebrew*) bee. Keepsake: a river stone.

DELIA (*Greek*) from Delos. Keepsake: a coat button.

DELILAH (*Hebrew*) delicate. Keepsake: a wreath.

DENISE (*French*) follower of Dionysus. Keepsake: a rolling pin.

DIANA (*Latin*) divine, the huntress. Keepsake: a garden trowel.

DOLORES (*Spanish*) sorrows. Keepsake: a cake stand.

DORA (*Greek*) gift. Keepsake: a wooden spoon.

DORIS (*Greek*) gift of the sea. Keepsake: a watering can.

DOROTHY (*Greek*) gift of God. Keepsake: a snow globe.



EDITH (*Old English*) prosperous in war. Keepsake: a skipping rope.

EDNA (*Hebrew*) pleasure, delight. Keepsake: a playing card.

EILEEN (*Irish*) bright, shining. Keepsake: a bicycle bell.

ELAINE (*French*) shining light. Keepsake: a serving spoon.

ELEANOR (*Provençal*) the other Aenor, or shining light. Keepsake: a woollen scarf.

ELIZABETH (*Hebrew*) God is my oath. Keepsake: a pocket watch.

ELLA (*Germanic*) other, foreign. Keepsake: a folded map.

ELLEN (*Greek*) torch, bright light. Keepsake: a paperweight.

ELOISE (*French*) healthy, wide. Keepsake: an acorn.

ELSIE (*Scots*) God is my oath. Keepsake: a teacup.

EMILY (*Latin*) rival, industrious. Keepsake: a feather.

EMMA (*Germanic*) whole, universal. Keepsake: a bell.

ERICA (*Norse*) eternal ruler. Keepsake: a picture frame.

ESME (*French*) esteemed, beloved. Keepsake: a bay leaf.

ESTELLE (*French*) star. Keepsake: an umbrella.

ESTHER (*Persian*) star. Keepsake: a keyring.

ETHEL (*Old English*) noble. Keepsake: a dinner bell.

EUGENIA (*Greek*) well-born. Keepsake: a nutmeg.

EVA (*Hebrew*) life. Keepsake: a pepper mill.

EVANGELINE (*Greek*) bearer of good news. Keepsake: a fountain pen.

EVELYN (*Norman*) wished-for child. Keepsake: a postage stamp.



FAITH (*English*) faith, trust. Keepsake: a skein of wool.

FELICITY (*Latin*) good fortune, happiness. Keepsake: a recipe card.

FIONA (*Gaelic*) fair, white. Keepsake: a bath sponge.

FLORA (*Latin*) flower. Keepsake: a ring box.

FLORENCE (*Latin*) flourishing, prosperous. Keepsake: a pincushion.

FRANCES (*Latin*) free one, Frenchwoman. Keepsake: a hairbrush.

FREYA (*Norse*) lady, the goddess of love. Keepsake: a vase.



GABRIELLE (*Hebrew*) God is my strength. Keepsake: a lampshade.

GEMMA (*Italian*) gem, precious stone. Keepsake: a drawer pull.

GENEVIEVE (*Germanic*) woman of the people. Keepsake: a clock key.

GEORGIA (*Greek*) farmer, earth-worker. Keepsake: a postcard.

GERALDINE (*Germanic*) ruler with the spear. Keepsake: a pocket calendar.

GERTRUDE (*Germanic*) spear of strength. Keepsake: a sugar bowl.

GILLIAN (*Latin*) youthful. Keepsake: a chess piece.

GLADYS (*Welsh*) princess, or lame. Keepsake: a cinnamon stick.

GLORIA (*Latin*) glory. Keepsake: a candle stub.

GRACE (*Latin*) grace, favour. Keepsake: a saucer.

GRETA (*Greek*) pearl. Keepsake: a single glove.

GWENDOLYN (*Welsh*) white ring, blessed ring. Keepsake: a quilt square.



HANNAH (*Hebrew*) grace, favour. Keepsake: a bread board.

HARRIET (*Germanic*) ruler of the home. Keepsake: an inkwell.

HAZEL (*Old English*) the hazel tree. Keepsake: a glass marble.

HEATHER (*Old English*) the heather plant. Keepsake: a jam jar.

HEIDI (*Germanic*) of noble kind. Keepsake: a slate pencil.

HELEN (*Greek*) torch, shining light. Keepsake: a whisk.

HENRIETTA (*Germanic*) ruler of the home. Keepsake: a magnifying glass.

HERMIONE (*Greek*) of Hermes, messenger. Keepsake: a mother-of-pearl button.

HILDA (*Germanic*) battle. Keepsake: a pressed flower.

HOLLY (*Old English*) the holly tree. Keepsake: a loaf tin.

HOPE (*English*) hope, expectation. Keepsake: a pickle jar.



IDA (*Germanic*) industrious. Keepsake: a bird feeder.

IMOGEN (*Celtic*) maiden, daughter. Keepsake: a shoehorn.

INGRID (*Norse*) beautiful, beloved of Ing. Keepsake: a jar of honey.

IRENE (*Greek*) peace. Keepsake: a diary.

IRIS (*Greek*) rainbow. Keepsake: an apron.

ISABEL (*Spanish*) God is my oath. Keepsake: a length of ribbon.

ISADORA (*Greek*) gift of Isis. Keepsake: a bookmark.

IVY (*Old English*) the ivy vine, faithfulness. Keepsake: a brass key.



JACQUELINE (*French*) supplanter. Keepsake: a seashell.

JANE (*Hebrew*) God is gracious. Keepsake: a dice.

JANET (*Scots*) God is gracious. Keepsake: a music box.

JASMINE (*Persian*) the jasmine flower. Keepsake: a coffee cup.

JEAN (*Scots*) God is gracious. Keepsake: a bud vase.

JENNIFER (*Cornish*) white wave, fair one. Keepsake: a salt shaker.

JESSICA (*Hebrew*) to behold. Keepsake: a kite.

JOAN (*Hebrew*) God is gracious. Keepsake: a soup ladle.

JOCELYN (*Germanic*) member of the Gauts. Keepsake: a spectacles case.

JOSEPHINE (*Hebrew*) God will increase. Keepsake: a whistle.

JOY (*English*) joy, rejoicing. Keepsake: a wooden bowl.

JUDITH (*Hebrew*) woman of Judea. Keepsake: a pie dish.

JULIA (*Latin*) youthful, downy-bearded. Keepsake: a nutcracker.

JULIET (*French*) little Julia. Keepsake: a domino.

JUNE (*Latin*) the month of Juno. Keepsake: a door wedge.

JUSTINE (*Latin*) just, fair. Keepsake: a brass compass.

R

KAREN (*Danish*) pure. Keepsake: a napkin ring.

KATHERINE (*Greek*) pure. Keepsake: a hairpin.

KATHLEEN (*Irish*) pure. Keepsake: a locket.

KAY (*English*) rejoice. Keepsake: a darning egg.

KIRSTEN (*Scandinavian*) follower of Christ. Keepsake: a candlestick.

Q

LAURA (*Latin*) the laurel, victory. Keepsake: a wind chime.

LAUREN (*Latin*) of Laurentum, the laurel. Keepsake: a hand mirror.

LEAH (*Hebrew*) weary, or wild cow. Keepsake: a spinning top.

LEONORA (*Greek*) light, compassion. Keepsake: a bottle of scent.

LILIAN (*Latin*) the lily. Keepsake: a spool of thread.

LILY (*Latin*) the lily, purity. Keepsake: a hair ribbon.

LINDA (*Spanish*) pretty, or tender. Keepsake: a toast rack.

LOIS (*Greek*) more desirable. Keepsake: a wooden clothes peg.

LORETTA (*Italian*) little laurel. Keepsake: a needle case.

LORNA (*Scots*) invented for a novel, of Lorne. Keepsake: a lump of coal.

LOUISA (*Germanic*) famous warrior. Keepsake: a cushion.

LUCIA (*Latin*) light. Keepsake: a blanket.

LUCILLE (*French*) light. Keepsake: a corkscrew.

LUCY (*Latin*) light. Keepsake: a teaspoon.

LYDIA (*Greek*) woman of Lydia. Keepsake: a gravy boat.

M

MABEL (*Latin*) lovable. Keepsake: a sprig of rosemary.

MADELEINE (*French*) woman of Magdala. Keepsake: a shoe buckle.

MAEVE (*Irish*) she who intoxicates. Keepsake: a tea strainer.

MARGARET (*Greek*) pearl. Keepsake: a tray.

MARGUERITE (*French*) pearl, or daisy. Keepsake: a wooden ruler.

MARIA (*Latin*) of Mary, sea of bitterness or beloved. Keepsake: a matchbox.

MARIAN (*French*) of Mary, star of the sea. Keepsake: a folding fan.

MARILYN (*English*) Mary and Lynn joined. Keepsake: a tea caddy.

MARJORIE (*Scots*) pearl. Keepsake: a sewing needle.

MARTHA (*Aramaic*) the lady, mistress of the house. Keepsake: a coin purse.

MARY (*Hebrew*) beloved, or sea of bitterness. Keepsake: a butter dish.

MATILDA (*Germanic*) mighty in battle. Keepsake: a tea towel.

MAUD (*Germanic*) mighty in battle. Keepsake: a tablecloth.

MAUREEN (*Irish*) little Mary. Keepsake: a doorknob.

MAVIS (*French*) the song thrush. Keepsake: a lantern.

MEGAN (*Welsh*) pearl. Keepsake: a flowerpot.

MELANIE (*Greek*) dark, black. Keepsake: a biscuit tin.

MELISSA (*Greek*) honeybee. Keepsake: a brooch.

MERCY (*English*) compassion, mercy. Keepsake: a silver thimble.

MEREDITH (*Welsh*) great lord, or sea lord. Keepsake: a bar of soap.

MILLICENT (*Germanic*) strong in work. Keepsake: a horseshoe.

MINERVA (*Latin*) the goddess of wisdom. Keepsake: a jigsaw piece.

MIRANDA (*Latin*) worthy of admiration. Keepsake: a parasol.

MIRIAM (*Hebrew*) beloved, or rebellious. Keepsake: a bundle of lavender.

MOIRA (*Irish*) great, or fate. Keepsake: a hymn book.

MOLLY (*Irish*) of Mary, beloved. Keepsake: a saltcellar.

MONICA (*Latin*) adviser, or alone. Keepsake: a stick of sealing wax.

MURIEL (*Irish*) bright sea. Keepsake: a coat hook.

MYRTLE (*Greek*) the myrtle plant. Keepsake: a pair of scissors.

N

NADIA (*Slavic*) hope. Keepsake: a garland.

NANCY (*Hebrew*) grace. Keepsake: a walking stick.

NAOMI (*Hebrew*) pleasantness. Keepsake: a cheese board.

NATALIE (*Latin*) birthday of the Lord.

Keepsake: a milk jug.

NELL (*English*) bright, shining one. Keepsake: a curtain ring.

NORA (*Latin*) honour. Keepsake: a pebble from the beach.

NORAH (*Irish*) honour. Keepsake: a photograph.

O

OCTAVIA (*Latin*) eighth. Keepsake: a tortoiseshell comb.

OLIVE (*Latin*) the olive tree, peace. Keepsake: a hat pin.

OLIVIA (*Latin*) the olive. Keepsake: a bookend.

OPAL (*Sanskrit*) precious stone. Keepsake: a soap dish.

OPHELIA (*Greek*) help, aid. Keepsake: a bracelet.

P

PAMELA (*Greek*) all sweetness. Keepsake: an egg cup.

PATIENCE (*English*) patience, endurance. Keepsake: a river stone.

PATRICIA (*Latin*) noble, of the patrician class. Keepsake: a small painted egg, of the sort kept in a box of birds.

PAULA (*Latin*) small, humble. Keepsake: a wreath.

PEARL (*English*) the pearl. Keepsake: a rolling pin.

PENELOPE (*Greek*) weaver. Keepsake: a garden trowel.

PHILIPPA (*Greek*) lover of horses. Keepsake: a cake stand.

PHOEBE (*Greek*) bright, radiant. Keepsake: a wooden spoon.

PHYLLIS (*Greek*) green bough, foliage. Keepsake: a watering can.

POLLY (*English*) of Molly and Mary. Keepsake: a snow globe.

PRISCILLA (*Latin*) ancient, venerable. Keepsake: a skipping rope.

PRUDENCE (*Latin*) good judgement. Keepsake: a playing card.

R

RACHEL (*Hebrew*) ewe. Keepsake: a bicycle bell.

RAMONA (*Spanish*) wise protector. Keepsake: a serving spoon.

REBECCA (*Hebrew*) to bind, captivating. Keepsake: a woollen scarf.

REGINA (*Latin*) queen. Keepsake: a pocket watch.

RHODA (*Greek*) rose. Keepsake: a folded map.

RITA (*Spanish*) pearl. Keepsake: a paperweight.

ROBERTA (*Germanic*) bright fame. Keepsake: an acorn.

ROSALIND (*Germanic*) gentle horse, or lovely rose. Keepsake: a teacup.

ROSAMUND (*Germanic*) horse protection, or rose of the world. Keepsake: a feather.

ROSE (*Latin*) the rose. Keepsake: a bell.

ROSEMARY (*Latin*) dew of the sea, the herb. Keepsake: a picture frame.

RUBY (*Latin*) the red gem. Keepsake: a bay leaf.

RUTH (*Hebrew*) companion, friend. Keepsake: an umbrella.

S

SABRINA (*Celtic*) the river Severn. Keepsake: a keyring.

SADIE (*Hebrew*) princess. Keepsake: a dinner bell.

SANDRA (*Greek*) defender of mankind. Keepsake: a nutmeg.

SARAH (*Hebrew*) princess, noblewoman. Keepsake: a small stuffed animal answering to the name Sushi.

SELINA (*Greek*) the moon. Keepsake: a fountain pen.

SHEILA (*Irish*) blind, or heavenly. Keepsake: a postage stamp.

SHIRLEY (*Old English*) bright meadow. Keepsake: a bottle kept for company, among the other bottles.

SIBYL (*Greek*) prophetess. Keepsake: a recipe card.

SOPHIA (*Greek*) wisdom. Keepsake: a bath sponge.

STELLA (*Latin*) star. Keepsake: a ring box.

SUSAN (*Hebrew*) lily. Keepsake: a pincushion.

SYLVIA (*Latin*) of the forest. Keepsake: a hairbrush.

T

TABITHA (*Aramaic*) gazelle. Keepsake: a vase.

TAMSIN (*Cornish*) twin. Keepsake: a lampshade.

TERESA (*Greek*) harvester, or of Thera. Keepsake: a drawer pull.

THEODORA (*Greek*) gift of God. Keepsake: a clock key.

TILLY (*Germanic*) mighty in battle. Keepsake: a postcard.

U

URSULA (*Latin*) little she-bear. Keepsake: a pocket calendar.

V

VALERIE (*Latin*) strong, healthy. Keepsake: a sugar bowl.

VANESSA (*English*) invented by Swift, a butterfly. Keepsake: a chess piece.

VERA (*Russian*) faith, or true. Keepsake: a cinnamon stick.

VERITY (*Latin*) truth. Keepsake: a candle stub.

VERONICA (*Latin*) true image. Keepsake: a saucer.

VICTORIA (*Latin*) victory. Keepsake: a single glove.

VIOLA (*Latin*) violet. Keepsake: a quilt square.

VIOLET (*Latin*) the violet flower. Keepsake: a bread board.

VIRGINIA (*Latin*) maiden, of the Verginius family. Keepsake: an inkwell.

VIVIAN (*Latin*) alive, lively. Keepsake: a glass marble.

W

WANDA (*Slavic*) wanderer, or a Vandal. Keepsake: a jam jar.

WENDY (*English*) invented by Barrie, a friend. Keepsake: a slate pencil.

WILHELMINA (*Germanic*) resolute protector. Keepsake: a whisk.

WILLA (*Germanic*) resolute protection. Keepsake: a magnifying glass.

WINIFRED (*Welsh*) blessed peace, reconciliation. Keepsake: a mother-of-pearl button.

Y

YVONNE (*French*) the yew tree. Keepsake: a pressed flower.

Z

ZELDA (*Yiddish*) blessed, happy. Keepsake: a loaf tin.

ZOE (*Greek*) life. Keepsake: a pickle jar.

The Cartomancer's Pocket Guide

THE MEANING OF EVERY CARD, AND WHERE ITS FORTUNE IS TO BE SOUGHT

As practised in the Kitchens of Europe · Sixth Printing

Draw a card, or be given one, or find one where no card ought to be. Read its meaning below, and then, if you are brave, go and look for its fortune in the place appointed. The places are traditional and have not been altered in six printings. The cards do not care whether you believe them.

♥ HEARTS — *matters of the heart*

ACE OF HEARTS — a new love, or an old one returning; its fortune is sought *in the cutlery drawer*.

TWO OF HEARTS — a meeting of two minds; its fortune is sought *beneath the doormat*.

THREE OF HEARTS — a letter that pleases; its fortune is sought *behind the clock*.

FOUR OF HEARTS — a change of dwelling; its fortune is sought *in a coat pocket*.

FIVE OF HEARTS — a gift given freely; its fortune is sought *under the bed*.

SIX OF HEARTS — a surprise visit; its fortune is sought *in the breadbox*.

SEVEN OF HEARTS — a broken promise, mended; its fortune is sought *behind a picture frame*.

EIGHT OF HEARTS — an invitation; its fortune is sought *in the fruit bowl*.

NINE OF HEARTS — a wish granted; its fortune is sought *inside a shoe*.

TEN OF HEARTS — the family gathered; its fortune is sought *under the bathmat*.

JACK OF HEARTS — a warm-hearted friend; its fortune is sought *on the highest shelf*.

QUEEN OF HEARTS — a kind and loyal woman; its fortune is sought *at the back of the upstairs toilet, where a noble woman does not look twice*.

KING OF HEARTS — a generous man; its fortune is sought *in the toaster oven*.

♦ DIAMONDS — *matters of money and the house*

ACE OF DIAMONDS — a ring, or an important document; its fortune is sought *in the letterbox*.

TWO OF DIAMONDS — a small quarrel over a small sum; its fortune is sought *behind the curtains*.

THREE OF DIAMONDS — a legal matter; its fortune is sought *in the umbrella stand*.

FOUR OF DIAMONDS — an inheritance; its fortune is sought *inside a book of poems*.

FIVE OF DIAMONDS — a prosperous venture; its fortune is sought *in the medicine cabinet*.

SIX OF DIAMONDS — an early marriage; its fortune is sought *in the vegetable drawer*.

SEVEN OF DIAMONDS — a loss, soon recovered; its fortune is sought *under the kettle*.

EIGHT OF DIAMONDS — a journey by land; its fortune is sought *in the sewing box*.

NINE OF DIAMONDS — a restless night; its fortune is sought *behind the mirror*.

TEN OF DIAMONDS — money from an unexpected quarter; its fortune is sought *in the laundry basket*.

JACK OF DIAMONDS — a messenger with news; its fortune is sought *in the spice drawer*.

QUEEN OF DIAMONDS — a woman fond of gossip; its fortune is sought *beneath the rug*.

KING OF DIAMONDS — a man of business; its fortune is sought *in the fridge door*.

♣ CLUBS — *matters of work and friendship*

ACE OF CLUBS — wealth and good fortune; its fortune is sought *under the sink*.

TWO OF CLUBS — an opposition overcome; its fortune is sought *in the sugar jar*.

THREE OF CLUBS — a happy marriage; its fortune is sought *in the bag of rice*.

FOUR OF CLUBS — a change for the worse, then better; its fortune is sought *behind the radiator*.

FIVE OF CLUBS — help from a friend; its fortune is sought *in the toolbox*.

SIX OF CLUBS — a business success; its fortune is sought *under the stairs*.

SEVEN OF CLUBS — a secret admirer; its fortune is sought *in the bath*.

EIGHT OF CLUBS — a run of good luck at games; its fortune is sought *on the windowsill*.

NINE OF CLUBS — a new friendship; its fortune is sought *in the sock drawer*.

TEN OF CLUBS — a long journey; its fortune is sought *nestled in the mixing bowls*.

JACK OF CLUBS — a dark-haired young man; its fortune is sought *in the hall closet*.

QUEEN OF CLUBS — a woman of quick temper; its fortune is sought *in the recycling*.

KING OF CLUBS — a faithful friend; its fortune is sought *at the bottom of the wardrobe*.

♠ SPADES — *matters of trouble and change*

ACE OF SPADES — a misfortune, or a great decision; its fortune is sought *in the tea caddy*.

TWO OF SPADES — a deception; its fortune is sought *under the lamp*.

THREE OF SPADES — a parting; its fortune is sought *in the bicycle basket*.

FOUR OF SPADES — illness, briefly; its fortune is sought *inside the chess set*.

FIVE OF SPADES — a difficulty at home; its fortune is sought *behind the books*.

SIX OF SPADES — a change of heart; its fortune is sought *in the freezer*.

SEVEN OF SPADES — a loss of a friend; its fortune is sought *in the desk drawer*.

EIGHT OF SPADES — a caution against haste; its fortune is sought *under the cutting board*.

NINE OF SPADES — the worst card, and then it passes; its fortune is sought *under the television*.

TEN OF SPADES — a night of worry; its fortune is sought *in the dishwasher*.

JACK OF SPADES — an untrustworthy young man; its fortune is sought *in a tub of protein powder*.

QUEEN OF SPADES — a widow, or a woman alone; its fortune is sought *in the salt cellar*.

KING OF SPADES — an ambitious man; its fortune is sought *inside the Coup box*.

THE JOKER (either colour) — the fool who knows everything and says nothing; the card that appears where it was not put. Its fortune is sought *in the Dutch oven*. Lift the lid. If there is a stew in it, you have the wrong Dutch oven and somebody should be told.

A Reader's Concordance

ONE WORD FROM EVERY PAGE, FOR THE READER WHO HAS NO TIME FOR THE REST

The Pocket Library Series · No. 9

THE PROPHET

by Kahlil Gibran

The busy reader cannot be expected to read a whole book, nor even a whole page. This concordance therefore names, for each page of *The Prophet*, the single word that the editors consider sufficient. Turn to the page, count as directed, and take the word. Count words as they are printed, hyphenated words as one, and do not count the page number, the chapter title, or your own doubts.

- | | | |
|--|---|---|
| 1. the sixth word of the last line. | 28. the second word of the last sentence. | 56. the fourth word of the last line. |
| 2. the fifth word of the last line. | 29. the third word of the last sentence. | 57. the last word of the sixth sentence. |
| 3. the first word of the first sentence on the page that begins with For . | 30. the seventh word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Much . | 58. the first word of the last line. |
| 4. the fourth word of the last sentence. | 31. the sixth word of the first line. | 59. the fifth word of the last sentence. |
| 5. the last word of the fifth sentence. | 32. the third word of the seventh line. | 60. the eighth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with And . |
| 6. the fourth word of the last sentence. | 33. the fifth word of the last sentence. | 61. the second word of the sixth line. |
| 7. the sixth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Love . | 34. the last word of the fourth sentence. | 62. the third word of the first line. |
| 8. the second word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Say . | 35. the third word of the eighth line. | 63. the third word of the last line. |
| 9. the first word of the fourth line. | 36. the second word of the last sentence. | 64. the sixth word of the last line. |
| 10. the seventh word of the fourth line. | 37. the fourth word of the seventh line. | 65. the fourth word of the last sentence. |
| 11. the seventh word of the last line. | 38. the fourth word of the last line. | 66. the eighth word of the eighth line. |
| 12. the fourth word of the first line. | 39. the eighth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Only . | 67. the fourth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with But . |
| 13. the third word of the fifth line. | 40. the fourth word of the second line. | 68. the fifth word of the last line. |
| 14. the seventh word of the eighth line. | 41. the fourth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with And . | 69. the last word of the second sentence. |
| 15. the sixth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Give . | 42. the fourth word of the last sentence. | 70. the fourth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Yet . |
| 16. the sixth word of the last sentence. | 43. the last word of the first sentence. | 71. the third word of the last sentence. |
| 17. the eighth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with When . | 44. the sixth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Say . | 72. the first word of the last sentence. |
| 18. the last word of the third sentence. | 45. the second word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Love . | 73. the eighth word of the first line. |
| 19. the sixth word of the last sentence. | 46. the eighth word of the fifth line. | 74. the fifth word of the fifth line. |
| 20. the fifth word of the last line. | 47. the first word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Even . | 75. the fifth word of the fourth line. |
| 21. the fourth word of the fourth line. | 48. the fourth word of the last sentence. | 76. the first word of the last line. |
| 22. the third word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Much . | 49. the sixth word of the first line. | 77. the last word of the first sentence. |
| 23. the third word of the fourth line. | 50. the fourth word of the last line. | 78. the sixth word of the last line. |
| 24. the last word of the sixth sentence. | 51. the last word of the first sentence. | 79. the second word of the sixth line. |
| 25. the first word of the last sentence. | 52. the third word of the last line. | 80. the last word of the first sentence. |
| 26. the fifth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Love . | 53. the eighth word of the seventh line. | 81. the first word of the ninth line. |
| 27. the fourth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with Yet . | 54. the fourth word of the last sentence. | 82. the sixth word of the last sentence. |
| | 55. the third word of the last sentence. | 83. the fifth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with But . |
| | | 84. the fifth word of the first sentence on the page that begins with For . |

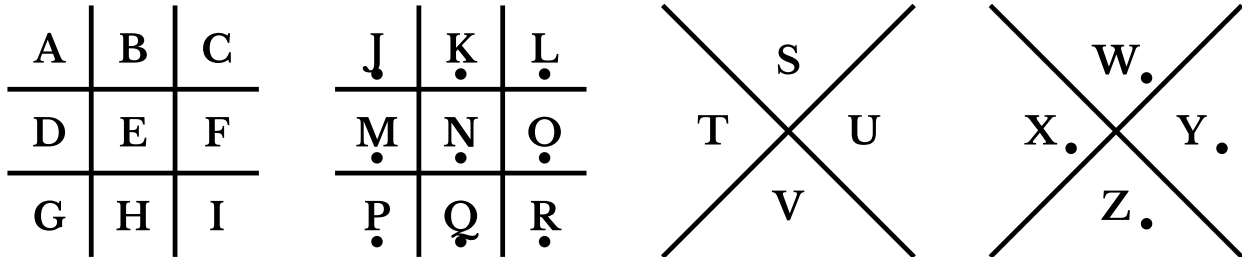
Where two or more pages are sought, the words so found are to be set side by side, in the order in which they were sought, and read as one.

The Pig-Pen Alphabet

A KEY TO THE CIPHER OF THE FREEMASONS, THE ROSICRUCIANS, AND SCHOOLCHILDREN

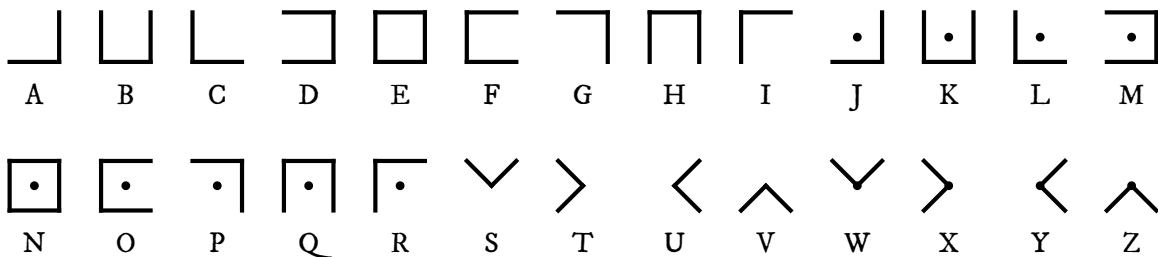
Pocket Library Series · No. 4

Each letter is written not by its name but by the shape of the pen it lives in. Find the letter in one of the four figures below and draw the lines that enclose it, and nothing else; the dot marks the second set. To read a message, do the same in reverse: match the shape to its pen, and take the letter that sits in it. The alphabet is set out in full underneath for the impatient.



The four pens. Left to right: letters A to I, letters J to R (dotted), S to V, W to Z (dotted).

THE ALPHABET IN FULL



FOR PRACTICE

The line below reads: THE QUICK BROWN FOX JUMPS OVER THE LAZY DOG



ONE NIGHT ONLY

ALL AGES

NO COVER

VUNDABAR

PERFORMING, IN FULL, THE HIT SINGLE

ALIEN BLUES

LIVE IN THE BATHROOM

UPSTAIRS • LEFT AT THE TOP • THE DOOR THAT STICKS

CHECK IT OUT!!!

★ ★ ★ ★ ★

FRI 12 SEP The Tote, Melbourne

SAT 13 SEP The Curtin, Carlton

THU 18 SEP Baby's All Right,
Brooklyn

FRI 19 SEP Elsewhere, Bushwick

SAT 20 SEP Union Pool,
Williamsburg

WED 24 SEP Great Scott, Allston

THU 25 SEP The Sinclair, Cambridge

TONIGHT THE BATHROOM, UPSTAIRS

SAT 27 SEP Johnny Brenda's,
Philadelphia

SUN 28 SEP Black Cat, Washington

TUE 30 SEP The Basement, Nashville

FRI 3 OCT Empty Bottle, Chicago

NOTES FOR THE AUDIENCE

The venue is small and the lighting is poor. Bring your own light.
The band asks that you read the wall before you read the set list.
Doors whenever you get there. No time will be announced. Just go.

	No. _____	
	<i>Read it twice. Then go and look.</i>	

	No. _____	
 _____		
	Read it twice. Then go and look.	

No. _____

Read it twice. Then go and look.

[illegible]

	No. _____	
	<i>Read it twice. Then go and look.</i>	

	No. _____	
 _____		
	Read it twice. Then go and look.	

No. _____

Read it twice. Then go and look.

No. _____

Read it twice. Then go and look.

No.	
Read it twice. Then go and look.	

	No. _____	
 _____		
	Read it twice. Then go and look.	

No.	
Read it twice. Then go and look.	

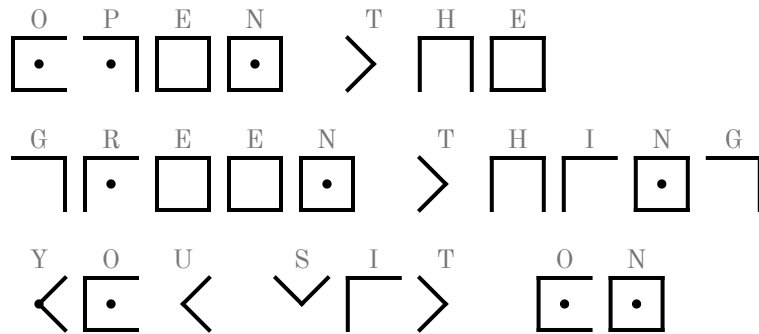
[illegible]

The Wall

TRACE THESE SHAPES IN INVISIBLE INK

Game-master copy · not for Sarah · remove before she arrives

Write **ALIEN BLUES** above these in dry-erase marker, then copy the shapes below beneath it in the invisible-ink pen. The small grey letter over each shape is what that shape means; do not copy the letters, only the shapes. Leave a clear gap between words.



Reads: **OPEN THE GREEN THING YOU SIT ON**

GAME-MASTER'S SETUP GUIDE • REMOVE THESE LEAVES BEFORE SHE ARRIVES

MINUTE ONE

HANDED TO HER: the letter and the Milk Crate painting.
The letter gives her the address sarahs.quest.

OUT IN THE OPEN: the nine printables, the flyer, the lemons,
the knife AND the scale, The Prophet, the locked suitcase.

OPEN AT THE SAME TIME • two lines, either order

Milk Crate painting, back → Ed Sheeran

Stars and Their Notes → The Barista's Hornpipe, two notes

Parlour Songbook, those two shapes → 12 and 15

Concordance + The Prophet, pages 12 and 15 → CORN BREAD

Receipt Book, cornbread → a game of backgammon

HIDE IN THE BACKGAMMON SET:
Plate II (the small disc with the hands) + Patricia painting

Put the knife on the scale → 79 g

Knife Catalogue, 79 g → No. 9, the Lemonade Knife

Cut the lemons open → the Joker

Cartomancer's Guide, the Joker → in the Dutch oven

HIDE IN THE DUTCH OVEN:
Plate I (the big dial), with a brad taped to it

OPENS WHEN THE MUSIC LINE IS DONE

Patricia painting → Register → a small painted egg...

HIDE IN THE WINGSPAN BOX:
Hamlet painting · fairy painting · a Queen of Hearts

THREE AT ONCE • any order

Queen of Hearts → Cartomancer's Guide
→ the back of the upstairs toilet

HIDE IN THE TOILET CISTERN:
the BLACK key (opens the suitcase)

Hamlet → Hamnet → Chloé Zhao
→ Register, Chloe → a jar of sweets

HIDE IN THE CANDY JAR:
blue-light pen · Abyssinia + Gleaners paintings

Fairy houses → Shirley
→ Register → a bottle kept for company

HIDE IN THE LIQUOR CABINET:
the Pig-Pen Alphabet sheet

THE LOCK • needs a piece from every line

Abyssinia + Gleaners + pigpen sheet → sarahs.quest. Ethiopia is
Figure VII (HALF PAST), Italy is Figure XIV (THREE) → 3:30 marker: BREATHE IN, BREATHE OUT. ink: OPEN THE GREEN THING YOU SEE

Flyer → bathroom. Blue-light pen + pigpen sheet

HIDE INSIDE THE MEDITATION CUSHION:
the card: DW₅OY₇ H₃W VKYJ LKRWQ

THE WHEEL: pin Plate II (hands) on Plate I (dial), set 3:30, decode the card
DW₅OY₇ H₃W VKYJ LKRWQ = BEHIND THE MANY FACES

HIDE BEHIND THE FRAMED PHOTO PUZZLE: the DARK BLUE key

BLACK key, from the cistern, opens the SUITCASE
early on. Inside: the backpack, still locked.

DARK BLUE key opens the BACKPACK
the prize

Nothing can be shortcut: the card is unreadable without both plates and the time, and those come from three different places.

PLAIN ENGLISH FOR THE THINGS WITH ODD NAMES

THE CONCORDANCE

The one-page sheet headed "A Reader's Concordance" with "The Prophet, by Kahlil Gibran" printed under the masthead. It gives one word-counting rule for each of 84 pages. She needs a real copy of The Prophet to use it; the sheet itself names the book, so put the book on the shelf among others and nothing more is needed.

PLATE I AND PLATE II

"Plate" always means one of the two cipher discs, and nothing else. Plate I, The Dial, is the big circle with clock numerals round the rim. Plate II, The Hands, is the smaller circle with two clock hands on it. Cut both out. Push a brad (split pin) through the centre of Plate I and tape it there; she lays Plate II on top and turns it until the hands read 3:30. So "hide Plate I in the Dutch oven" simply means: put the big disc in the Dutch oven.

FIGURE I TO FIGURE XX

The twenty flag cards on sarahs.quest. They carry no country names, only numbers, so Figure VII is the seventh card along. She never needs the number; she recognises Ethiopia and Italy by their colours. The numbers are only here so you can check the right card without counting.

PIGPEN

A cipher where each letter is drawn as the walls of the box it sits in. The printed Pig-Pen Alphabet sheet is the key. The only pigpen you write by hand is the wall; the flags' pigpen is already on the website.

WHEEL SYMBOLS

Ordinary letters and digits that only mean something once the wheel is set. You copy them onto the cushion card exactly as printed below.

LOCK AND LOAD, IN THIS ORDER, SO NO KEY ENDS UP LOCKED INSIDE ITS OWN BOX

1. Put the prize in the backpack. Close it and padlock it. Its key is **DARK BLUE**.
2. Put the backpack inside the suitcase. Close the suitcase and padlock it. Its key is **BLACK**.
3. Stand the suitcase somewhere she will see it all evening. It is meant to taunt.
4. Hide **BLACK** in a ziplock in the toilet cistern. She reaches it mid-game, opens the suitcase, and finds the backpack still locked. That is the moment the evening turns.
5. Tape **DARK BLUE** flat to the back of the framed photo puzzle. Masking tape, pressed down so it cannot rattle. Nothing points here until the wheel is decoded.
6. **PURPLE** and **LIGHT BLUE** are not used. Put them in a drawer.

Two locks is the whole scheme. The wheel exists to produce the second key, so it cannot be skipped.

EVERY HIDING PLACE AND WHAT GOES IN IT

PLACE	CONTENTS
HER HANDS	The welcome letter and the Milk Crate painting. Nothing is hidden on the painting; its back just carries the written clue.
OUT IN THE OPEN	The nine printables scattered about; the flyer on the fridge; a bowl of lemons, one loaded; the knife and the kitchen scale on the counter; The Prophet on the shelf among many books; the locked suitcase
BACKGAMMON SET	Plate II; the Patricia painting
WINGSPAN BOX	The Hamlet painting; the fairy painting; a real Queen of Hearts playing card
TOILET CISTERN	The BLACK key in a ziplock bag. Nothing else, ever. No paper, no paintings.
THE CANDY JAR	The blue-light pen; the Abyssinia painting; the Gleaners painting. Roll the paintings or lay them under the jar if they will not fit inside.
LIQUOR CABINET	The Pig-Pen Alphabet key sheet
DUTCH OVEN	Plate I, with a brad (split pin) taped to it
BATHROOM WALL OR MIRROR	ALIEN BLUES in dry-erase marker; the pigpen glyphs from the tracing sheet in invisible ink beneath
INSIDE THE MEDITATION CUSHION	The cipher card, in a small envelope, tucked just inside the zip where a hand will meet it
BEHIND THE FRAMED PHOTO PUZZLE	The DARK BLUE key, taped flat to the back of the frame. Nothing points here until the wheel is decoded, so it is never searched.
SUITCASE	The backpack. The suitcase itself is padlocked with the BLACK lock and left in plain sight all evening.
BACKPACK	The prize. Padlocked with the DARK BLUE lock. All six paintings are placed elsewhere; none is in here.

1 • THE WELCOME LETTER. Your words, your handwriting. It must do three jobs and no more: give her the address `sarahs.quest`; warn her that some things she finds will not make sense on the day she finds them; and end with a line in your own voice. Do not explain any puzzle. Do not mention the suitcase. If you are stuck for an opening: *“There are six paintings in this apartment and every one of them is a question. You will need a scale, a knife, a pin, and more patience than I deserve.”*

2 • THE SIX PAINTING BACKS. Write these on the quarter-sheet frames and clip or tape one to each painting.

MILK CRATE — *The famous man we always see here, who is not him.*

PATRICIA’S — *Just the name. Look her up.*

HAMLET — *We saw the film of this play. Whose film was it? Look her up by her first name.*

FAIRY HOUSES — *What was the family name of the one who lived here? Look her up.*

ABYSSINIA — *This country has another name now. Find its colours at `sarahs.quest`, and turn them over.*

GLEANERS — *The café sits in a market named for a country. Its colours are at `sarahs.quest` too. You will need this one and Abyssinia both.*

3 • THE WALL. Two inks, and the order matters.

IN DRY-ERASE MARKER, large, so she can read it the moment she walks in:

ALIEN BLUES

BREATHE IN, BREATHE OUT.

IN THE INVISIBLE-INK PEN, underneath, copy the shapes from the tracing sheet two pages back. They read OPEN THE GREEN THING YOU SIT ON. Each shape has its letter above it in grey; copy the shapes only, never the letters. The visible half is atmosphere and gives nothing away; the hidden half is the answer, so she still needs the pen and the pig-pen sheet to get there. Test a corner first: glass and glazed tile wipe clean, grout and stone do not. The mirror is the safest surface in the room.

4 • THE CIPHER CARD. Any scrap of paper. In capitals, exactly, with the spaces where they are:

DW5OY7 H5W VKYJ LKR WQ

Put it in a small envelope. On the envelope write: *This will mean nothing until the hour is set.* Tuck it just inside the cushion’s zip, where a hand will meet it straight away.

5 • THREE HINT ENVELOPES (optional, but they save the evening). Seal three envelopes and label them *If you are stuck on the music, If you are stuck on the knife*, and *If you are stuck at the very end*. Inside each, one sentence: *Everything you need is at `sarahs.quest/hints.html` — and I will not think less of you.*

WHAT YOU DO NOT WRITE

The flags’ pigpen is already on the website. The register, the card guide, the concordance, the songbook, the knife catalogue and the recipe book are printed and final. The only cipher you draw by hand is the wall.

THE FIVE TESTS, BEFORE SHE ARRIVES

1. **The knife.** Put your real knife on your real scale. It must read 79 g. The nearest catalogue entries are 58 g and 99 g, so you have about 14 g of slack either way. If it is wildly off, pick a different knife.
2. **The book.** Open your copy of *The Prophet*. Page 12, fourth word of the first line, must be **corn**. Page 15, the first sentence beginning “Give”, sixth word, must be **bread**. Editions differ and this is the single most likely thing to break.
3. **The wall.** Shine the blue-light pen on your writing. The shapes must show clearly. Then wipe a corner to be certain it comes off.
4. **The wheel.** Cut both plates, pin them, set the hands to half past three, and decode the cipher card yourself. It must read BEHIND THE MANY FACES.
5. **The website.** Open [sarahs.quest](#) on your phone. Tap Figure VII, the green-yellow-red flag with the blue disc: its back must read HALF PAST. Then tap Figure XIV, the green-white-red vertical stripes: its back must read THREE. Together they give half past three.

THE ORDER TO SET THE ROOM UP

1. Lock the backpack, put it in the suitcase, lock the suitcase, stand it in the open.
2. Hide the two keys: BLACK in the cistern, DARK BLUE behind the framed puzzle.
3. Place all six paintings: Milk Crate in her envelope; Patricia in the backgammon set; Hamlet and the fairy houses in the Wingspan box with the Queen of Hearts; Abyssinia and Gleaners with the candy jar. None goes in the backpack.
4. Plate II in the backgammon set. Plate I in the Dutch oven. Pig-pen sheet in the liquor cabinet.
5. Load one lemon with the Joker and set the bowl out. Knife and scale on the counter.
6. Cipher card into the cushion. Write the wall. Flyer on the fridge.
7. Scatter the printed sheets around the room. The Prophet onto the shelf among other books.
8. Tear the last six leaves out of the printed packet and hide them from yourself.

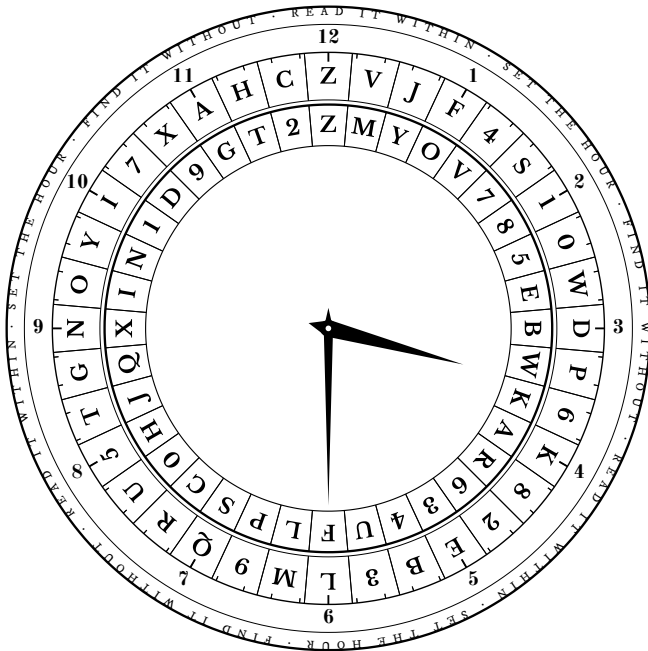
IF SHE STALLS

[sarahs.quest/hints.html](#) holds eighteen predicaments, each with a nudge, then a firmer nudge, then the answer outright. It is linked in a box at the top of the flags page, so she can reach it on her own and you never have to be the one who gives it away. Or just tell her; you are allowed.

Cipher Solution Sheet

FOR THE GAME-MASTER ONLY • DO NOT PRINT FOR SARAH

How it works. Plate II (the hands) is pinned on top of Plate I (the dial) and turned until the hands read **3:30** on the dial's clock numerals: the short hand pointing straight at the **3** and the long hand straight at the **6**. That is a turn of 200° clockwise from the printed position. The rim of the dial says *find it without, read it within*: a secret message is written in **dial symbols**; for each one, find it on the outer dial and read the symbol lined up with it on the inner disc. Letters and digits both take part, so you can hide a number, a time, or a word.



Dial	Hands	Dial	Hands	Dial	Hands
A	G	B	4	C	2
D	B	E	3	F	0
G	Q	H	T	I	1
J	Y	K	A	L	F
M	L	N	X	O	I
P	W	Q	S	R	C
S	7	T	J	U	0
V	M	W	E	X	9
Y	N	Z	Z	0	5
1	8	2	6	3	U
4	V	5	H	6	K
7	D	8	R	9	P

Example. Plain: LOOK BEHIND THE MIRROR AT 3 30

Written for Sarah (dial symbols): MFF6 DW50Y7 H5W VO88F8 KH E EU

To make your own: `python3 escape-room/src/cipher_data.py YOUR MESSAGE HERE`

Plate II's hands are deliberately printed at an angle that reads as no sensible time; only when turned 200° do they show 3:30. If you would rather a different answer, change `SOLUTION_TIME`, `HOURL_ANGLE`, `MINUTE_ANGLE` and `ROT` in `src/cipher_data.py` (`ROT` must be a multiple of 10) and rebuild.